LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP meets on **Thursday at 6.00pm** in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome

PILGRIMAGES TO MEDJUGORJE & LOURDES 2027 Deposits and Savings scheme available on Thursdays in Parochial House from 10.30am-12noon.beginning in October. contact Margaret 07732468511

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION WORKSHOPS November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation Thursday 19 November, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend! For any further information please contact us at columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99



Sun 8th Nov 2026 Vol 44 No 44

MASSES
Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS
Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS - Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES
Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE - 71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

READINESS AND WEARINESS Matthew 25:1–1

Readiness is compatible with weariness. In the parable of the ten bridesmaids, all ten fall asleep, including the wise. Jesus does not condemn their tiredness. The difference lies in the oil they have brought.
We might understand that oil as our willingness to open our hearts to Christ: to receive his love, acknowledge our need, and allow him to sustain us. We cannot manufacture grace, but we can make room to receive it.
Sometimes we imagine that being ready for God means having everything accomplished, our problems resolved, and our weaknesses overcome. Yet Christ can meet us amid unfinished tasks, anxious thoughts, and tired bodies. Our weariness need not close our hearts.
Even a simple prayer can keep the lamp of faith burning: "Lord, I am tired, but I am here. Help me welcome you."
The Bridegroom comes to gather us into his joy. Readiness means remaining willing to receive the love he offers, even when we have little strength.

NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP will continue on Tuesday at the 7.15pm Mass. Please place Petitions in the box at the front of the altar.

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Paul McElhinney, Elizabeth Breslin, Maire Coyle, Margaret Hasson, Benny McLaughlin

SUNDAY COLLECTION 1st Nov £2506.36 & €161.91 Standing Orders £400 **2nd Collection** £932.51 & €54.60 Thank you for your generosity

HOLY FAMILY PARISH DRAW
Our Parish Draw will begin in January 2027 to provide funds for the refurbishment and future capital needs of our Parish. Monthly subscription of **£10 by standing order or cash payment of £120 for year**. Part payments for a ticket can be made to the parish office over the next twelve weeks Tickets on sale and standing order forms available after Masses every weekend or at the parish office from this weekend. All standing order and cash payments need to be completed by 10th January for the first draw on **Saturday 30th Jan.** A subscriber to the Draw must be at least 18 years of age.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD
During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come. There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, today Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, pgoh2111@gmail.com (028) 79386259

DERRY DIOCESAN PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES 2027, led by Bishop Michael Router: There are two options available as follows:
Option 1: 8 - 13 July, 5 nights, £980, from City of Derry Airport, with priority given to Assisted Pilgrims and family members, Care Team, Youth, Youth Leaders and Priests
Option 2: 7 - 14 July, 7 nights, £1,095, from Belfast International Airport.
Single Supplement and Travel Insurance will be extra. Expressions of Interest can be emailed to derrypilgrim@outlook.com. Bookings will begin in mid-January, with more details later. Pilgrimage Gift Vouchers of any value are available from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop Street, Derry, for anyone wishing to purchase them, particularly as a Christmas Gift. Please contact 028 7136 2475 for further info.

ANAM CARA'S next Bereavement Information Evening will centre around where creativity intersects with grief with renowned author and psychotherapist, Sasha Bates. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. This event will take place online on Thursday 19 November at 7pm. For more info info@anamcara.ie or call 085 288 8888

FREE 4- Week Dementia Education Programme for Family Carers
Starting Thursday 21 January 2027, 7.00pm at the Health for Life Healthy Living Centre, Creggan. Designed for those supporting a loved one with a dementia diagnosis at home. Learn about dementia, communication, behaviours, coping strategies, and available supports. Family members are welcome to attend together. Please note: this course is not suitable for people living with dementia or those currently undergoing assessment/diagnosis. **Booking essential:** eilish.brown@healthforlifenw.org | 028 7137 3870.